

Chapter 103

Fuses

This chapter introduces Fuses, which are scriptable plugins that can be used within Fusion.

Contents

Fuses [Fus].....	2295
Fuses Introduction.....	2295
Installing Fuses	2295
Working with Fuses in a Composition	2295

Fuses [Fus]



A Fuse node

Fuses Introduction

Fuses are plugins. The difference between a Fuse and an Open FX plugin is that a Fuse is created using a Lua script. Fuses can be edited within Fusion or DaVinci Resolve, and the changes you make compile on-the-fly.

Using a Lua script makes it easy for even non-programmers to prototype and develop custom nodes. A new Fuse can be added to a composition, edited and reloaded, all without having to close the current composition. They can also be used as modifiers to manipulate parameters, curves, and text very quickly. ViewShader Fuses can make use of the GPU for faster performance. This makes Fuses much more convenient than an Open FX plugin that uses Fusion's OFX SDK. However, this flexibility comes at a cost. Since a Fuse is compiled on-the-fly, it can be significantly slower than the identical node created using the Open FX SDK.

As an example, Fuses could generate a mask from the over-exposed areas of an image, or create initial particle positions based on the XYZ position stored within a text file.

Please contact Blackmagic Design for access to the SDK (Software Developer Kit) documentation.

Installing Fuses

Fuses are installed in the Fusion:\Fuses path map. By default this folder is located at Users/ User_Name/Library Application Support/Blackmagic Design/Fusion (or DaVinci Resolve)/Fuses on macOS or C:\Users\User_Name\AppData\Roaming\Blackmagic Design\Fusion (or DaVinci Resolve)\Fuses, on Windows. Files must use the extension .fuse, or they will be ignored by Fusion.

Working with Fuses in a Composition

Fuses can be designed to appear in any category in the Effects Library. Once installed, they are added to a composition exactly as any native or third-party plugin node. However, since a Fuse is just a text document, it can be edited by clicking the Edit button that appears at the top of the Inspector when the Fuse node is selected. This will open the Fuse in the default script editor specified in the Global Preferences/Scripting panel.

NOTE: Any changes made to a Fuse's script do not immediately affect other copies of the same Fuse node already added to a composition. To use the updated Fuse script on all similar Fuses in the composition, either close and reopen the composition, or click on the Reload button in each Fuse's Inspector.

When a composition containing a Fuse node is opened, the currently saved version of the Fuse script is used. The easiest way to ensure that a composition is running the current version of a Fuse is to close and reopen the composition.